

Medford School Committee - Special Summer Meeting Notes
Monday, July 13, 2020 - 6 PM - Via Zoom

Mayor - Meeting called to order - 6:02 PM - Member Van der Kloot please call the roll

Roll Call - 7-0

Mayor - Motion to approve the June 15th meeting minutes by Member Kreatz, seconded by Member McLaughlin.

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Motion to approve bills by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Member Graham - Did we receive statements? What are we approving?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The reports were completed today and emailed to you.

Mr. Parquette - FY 20 and FY 21 - and a bill from City but there are no accounts payable

Member Graham - Before we vote, there appears to be \$305,000 in funding. How can we use that funding in FY 21?

Mr. Parquette - We are still waiting for Ms. Patterson to do some year end closing - and Ms. Nunley sent over some revolving account information. Once all of that is completed, I will inform you if anything is available for a carryover

Member Ruseau - I am looking for email that contains this item

Member McLaughlin -It was in a 2:50 PM email

Member Kreatz - I'll forward it to you

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - It should be inside the drive as well

Member Ruseau - Can you provide the details, just so I am aware?

Mr. Parquette - It included details of FY 20 school budget and the off week payroll.

Motion to approve by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Member/Kreatz

Roll Call Vote 7-0 - paper is approved

Mayor - Report of Secretary?

Member Van der Kloot - There is none

Mayor - Motion to approve COW notes of June 15, 2020 by Member Graham, seconded by Member Kreatz

Roll Call Vote 7-0 - paper passes

Mayor - June 29th - Public Hearing - FY 21 Budget, Madam Superintendent

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I have asked Mr. Glenn Koocher, Executive Director for MASC to speak in regards to the budget process

Mr. Koocher - There seems to have been some concern regarding the budget process. The law requires that a budget is presented to the Mayor within 170 days - Due to covid, this has been put on hold by the Governor, but the Mayor still has an obligation to get a budget to the council by the end of year - we are in an unprecedented situation - the closest situation for me to compare it to, is 1980 when the voters approved Prop 2 ½ -the state wasn't able to mitigate it all until much later in the year - If school committee didn't approve the budget, the Council could do so with a 2/3 majority - Additionally, the council could come up with additional money, if it was available. To not pass a budget, meant cities/towns could not have checks ready on payday and maybe even have to shutdown. A number of school committees were operating under the assumption they wouldn't be operating as of July 1st, so we were giving advice to districts to get your budgets done, as someone else might do it for you and you might not like it - Questions still remain about Chapter 70, circuit breaker and discretionary monies along with the federal government.

Member McLaughlin - Thank you for helping to explain the process . Would you have access to a visual flowchart that you could share with us?

Mr. Koocher - The Massachusetts General Laws do explain it, which the Superintendent does have a copy of.

Member Graham - Would you have any advice for us, with the back and forth we are in? It is in fact the Mayor's budget and we need to meet her numbers. Is there anyway we could move past this? What do other cities/towns do? How do we get out of the cycle of not having enough?

Mr. Koocher - Historically the Legislature has always waited resulting in a continuing frustration amongst local school boards. Therefore, that frustration is often shared with Mayors and Superintendents. There are no easy answers unfortunately.

Member Graham - Is it a problem in our own house? We are operating to a number, and there is frankly no other way to do it - We did send \$9 M memo to Council with additional district requests

Mr. Koocher - Well, the best way to respond to that is to compare it to the Boston Red Sox, they never have enough pitching, the cops and chief never get along and Chapter 70 never has never funding. There will always be more demands for money than supply will sustain - for example: improved services, increased salaries, more programs - it's the way it is - we have to deal with the political process - the desire for programs will always supercede the funding available

Member Ruseau - But we are talking about the right number of staff to get all kids to be able to read - our society thinks a sidewalk is more important than our students being able to read. The vast majority of the \$9M wasn't a wish list - no reading specialists in high school for example - it's more needed services

Mr. Koocher - I respect it and those concerns are shared by many of your colleagues across the state

Member McLaughlin - We just really want to understand the process and the community does as well. I just really wish there was training or visuals.

Mr. Koocher - Please look out for our upcoming training regarding Chapter 70 monies

Member McLaughlin - Thank you

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Thank you to Mr. Koocher for joining us today. It is very much appreciated

Mayor - Yes thank you Mr. Koocher for your time. We appreciate it.

Mayor - Motion to approve minutes of June 29th, Committee of the Whole Public Hearing?

Member Graham - on Page 18, reports were requested for past school year rate cards on school rentals, as well as, to review freshmen sports possibly being funded by charging a fee for middle school sports. So, please add to the August 17th agenda. I'll make motion to approve with these amendments, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - minutes passed with amendments

Mayor - Are there any community questions/comments

Member Ruseau - We have not received any questions.

Mayor - Thank you, the Superintendent's Report

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I have some brief remarks, first from an operational perspective, the Medford Public Schools have brought back (77) teachers. Also, we are advertising for (19) additional teaching positions. Our goal has always been to keep teachers in the classroom and we continue to move forward with that goal everyday. In regards to our Re entry Task Force Working Group, we are pleased that over 220 people have applied to serve. A more detailed report will be presented tonight by Dr. Cushing, Ms. Galusi and Mr. Milaschewski. For seniors who applied for the Connors Scholarship, there has been a delay in announcing recipients due to covid. Former Mayor McGlynn who sits on the scholarship board apologized for the wait and will get back to us shortly with those who will be receiving the scholarship. The Medford Family Network has not stopped providing services and trainings for our families. Their July Newsletter was released this past Friday and it is up on the Blog and the website. Additionally, the Medford Family Network in conjunction with the Medford Public Schools Clinical Services continues to present virtually the Parents of Children with Autism Spectrum Disorder Support Group. It will be held Wednesday, July 29th from 6:30 - 7:30 PM. Last week, CCSR students from Medford High School, worked together with Mayor Lungo-Koehn's Office and the Department of Public Works, to clean and beautify the area surrounding Fountain Street. This is one of many summer clean ups that CCSR hopes to work on to help keep Medford clean. Currently, CCSR is working together with Tufts University to possibly provide a drive in movie event in August. The Senior Class of 2020 received their yearbooks last week. If a senior still did not receive their yearbook, please contact Mr. Blauch. The Middle School yearbooks are on the way. Mr. Tucci and Mr. Downs will inform their students when the yearbooks have arrived. The Andrews Middle School community hosted a food drive for families prior to

summer vacation. Staff and families made donations and over 80 bags of non-perishable food items were collected. Principal Downs split the bags between two of our local food pantries.

Mayor - Yes. CCSR was great at helping to clean and beautify Webster Park and Fountain Street. We plan to do a clean up every week. We are very lucky to have CCSR. They are a wonderful group of students.

Toni Wray - Covid Update - as of July 12th - increased testing sites - (8) testing sites available in cities that surround us. Statewide, there has been a 94% decrease in positive cases - deaths have decreased by 89% - all of this is very promising data. We are ranging from 0-6 positive cases per week in Medford - please continue social distancing, wearing masks and washing hands.

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I am very excited to be able to announce we have a new school business official, Mr. David Murphy, will become our new Assistant Superintendent of Finance and Operation. He comes to us with over 15 years of educational experience, including serving on the Attleboro School Committee where he served as the Chairperson, and serving as the Deputy Superintendent and Legal Counsel for the Boston Public Schools. He is a Fordham and Boston College Law School graduate. We are thrilled to welcome David to our team

Mayor - Welcome Mr. Murphy

Mayor - Report on K-12 enrollment

Dr. Cushing - The registrations are going well. Kindergarten registration is great, but grades 1-12 are not as robust. Our plan is to reopen the Parent Information with plexiglass and other safety protocols. Our enrollment numbers in June were 4,054 and today they were down a bit to 4,038.

Ruseau - Can we identify if parents plan to opt out and home school?

Mayor -What about Lexington's plan?

Dr. Cushing - We are still in the process of contacting student's families, one to one, not just regarding transportation, but also regarding remote learning or home schooling.

Member McLaughlin - Point of information - we will be doing the same for out of district families?

Dr. Cushing - all families - absolutely!

Member Ruseau - We know every year kids register for Kindergarten and then don't show up.

Member Van der Kloot - I think this year, we really have a chicken and egg problem - parents don't know what they are doing until we announce our plans

Member Graham - I talked to Tom about it in the communication subcommittee. If parents know they are definitely not sending their child back, regardless of our plans, they should reach out and let us know? What happened or where did those 16 students go?

Dr. Cushing - I know two withdrew to attend an online school.

Member Graham - The numbers at the middle schools seem to have more of a gap than usual? Is it due to the EL program?

Dr. Cushing - That is on my radar to look into it further

Ms. Evangelista - I will say, parents do call the Superintendent's Office to inquire as to whom to speak to regarding homeschooling. Additionally, often other districts contact the Superintendent's Office for us to send records to them for our former students who are now with them.

Mayor - Technology Report, Ms. Laden

Ms. Laden - Regarding the distribution of chromebooks - about a $\frac{1}{3}$ of our devices - went out - now we are collecting them back with a significant number have been collected - elementary students kept theirs for use during the month of July - at this point, we will have them keep them for now. CARES Act -will bring in significant devices to the district, along with looking to add (50) hotspots through T-Mobile, and we will be Investing in online library resources. We are excited to go 1-1 with devices for all the high school students. Additionally, we have purchased (20) charging carts which will go to the K-8 schools. There are 1826 chromebooks on order and they should be in on time. We ordered 133 with Title 4 funding. Depending on what we get back in working order - we will almost be 1-1 in chromebooks district wide. High school will take home, K-8 will be assigned a device but will leave at school, unless we go onto remote learning. Our goal is to assign the devices similar to the library book system. Also, DESE has provided a new funding possibility, called remote learning essentials. This grant will depend on how many districts apply and how much money they apply for. It is a very narrowly focused grant that can only be used specifically for devices/internet access & assisted technology. So I'm looking for it for assistive microphones, headsets, and chrome tablets for our youngest students

who don't need to access a keyboard. The application is due at the end of July, and we won't be notified until sometime in August. Lastly, we have continued to maintain our website and remote learning sites.

Member Van der Kloot - Thank you Molly. This is a lot of good news. If money comes into the district, can we order devices for teachers? Or can we give teachers a small payment for using their own device?

Ms. Laden - We have had discussions about updating teacher desktops, for a more robust mobile device, but it is a significant expense. The flip side of that would be that we wouldn't have to update their desktops. If we get funding from the state grant, then maybe we could move money from CARES Act to purchase some teacher devices

Member Ruseau - Do we have an estimated delivery date?

Ms. Laden - Mid August - we haven't been pushed out since - as other districts have been pushed out to mid September

Member Ruseau - Will it be one massive delivery? Or separate shipments?

Ms. Laden - Actually, a Medford company has them, so they would be able to drop off the 1300 devices to MHS.

Ruseau -how much time does it take to set up the devices?

Molly - the free cash money was used last time - our library staff is trained to do it - the library staff will start the barcode system - all managed by our google classrooms - mostly it's an issue of time to try to be able to do it - a lot of devices and just the logistics of timing

Member Ruseau -How did we come to the number of (50) hotspots?

Ms. Laden - The number I've heard is (35) but we aren't sure we reached everyone and if (50) isn't enough I have some CARES money to use if needed

Member Graham - Thank you of the 2,023 devices we have, how many will age out soon?

Ms. Laden -About 100 will age out next year and in 2022 - about 600 will age out

Member Graham -Why do the older devices go to the elementary and middle schools?

Ms. Laden - We want each school to have all the same devices to service everyone better

Member Graham - The faculty too?

Ms. Laden - These are just student devices, not faculty

Member Graham - If we can figure how to order for teachers, as chrome books can't really handle running a classroom...

Ms. Laden - We must also figure out how to deal with ordering additional devices for those aging out.

Member Graham -Will the devices have location tracking, so you can see it when I turn it on?

Ms. Laden - We will be using a barcode system, district wide. But you mean more of a "find my iphone" program, correct?

Member Graham - Yes. I've had to use it professionally. Do we have an existing policy, "a take your device home plan"? Or do we as a committee have to develop one?

Ms. Laden - We have a consent form for remote learning, similar to what other districts have done for 1-1 devices. We can have insurance options for families and filtering, but not finalized yet. We had no time to do that when Covid hit.

Member Graham -In regards for potential funding, meaning it's more than just handing off a device and charger to students...especially for younger students, a mouse and a headset, are very helpful. If we have the opportunity to bolster our accessories & even purchase protective cases, are there any grant funding options available for that?

Ms. Laden - Yes, I've thought of that, bumper cases for younger students & headsets and microphones for teachers

Member Kreatz - Thank you for a wonderful report. I know you mentioned the ongoing development of the remote learning site, are those sites completed?

Ms. Laden - Both sites should be live? I will check. Kris Johnson of our middle school did them and middle school tech teacher Courtney Bell assisted teachers on things they needed and

then the other site was for families - we will continue to populate it as we are asked and update the sites as needed.

Member Ruseau - As we move to 1-1 at MHS - students will be bringing them to school, we can't handle that many devices on the network though?

Ms. Laden - That is something we have discussed - Mr. Arena will need to make that network more robust

Dr. Edouard-Vincent- (50) wireless access points at MHS - in every other classroom that would allow the system to carry the additional devices - on our radar to make sure the devices are in, we would add those additional access points - we did take that into consideration - they are not connected yet - allowing for double coverage

Member Ruseau - I believe that wireless access at MHS is awful. I don't want students not to be able to connect on day 1 - the fix for that is not an afternoon fix - so that is concerning - critical path issue for me - maybe someone should double check the math - when we did the upgrade a few years ago, not much changed - the other thing, when we give out the chromebooks there was a laptop bag for it, so do all of them come with those?

Ms. Laden - All the high school devices will come with a bag, but K-8 will use same device every day and leave at school

Member Ruseau - Insurance issue? Kids dropping a device for example or a friend broke their laptop - I don't want it to be an issue - as most students will be somewhat fragile - self insurance for those on free/reduced lunch

Ms. Laden - Yes

Mayor - Thank you Ms. Laden. Now we will hear from Mr. Teixeira and Dr. Chiesa about the grant applications for Early Literacy K-3 and English Learners 9-12.

Mr. Texiera - We applied for 2 building based early literacy grants, for both the McGlynn and the Columbus. We probably won't get both, but hoping for one. The grants are focused on K-3 - a coach to work with a core group of teachers (6) - to develop a literacy program across grade levels K-3 and then a separate group of teachers would look at that data. The extended school grant would be for beginning level EL students at MHS. If we received that grant, it could only be used for afterschool, vacation or summer based programs.

Dr. Chiesa - The literacy grants were broken up into different parts - consultant, assessment tools and materials

Mayor - Great thank you - What is the timeline when grants would be awarded?

Mr. Teixeira - They were submitted last week and it will be determined in August - If the additional school were to be considered, it would be much later in August.

Mayor - Did we submit one before the other?

Mr. Teixeira - No submitted at same time - we used different data for each school, focusing on looking at a growth model vs. looking at a baseline. The EL grants is specific to extend the 20-21 school year, for school vacation weeks, or weekend activities -as we have a summer program through Title 3 - I chose weekends from Dec-May - extra schooling, Level 1 & 2 - high school level - we'd find that out in August as well.

Member Ruseau - Is this a good idea? Meaning are we going to look into a way to eventually add to the budget? How would you classify this?

Mr. Teixeira - Early literacy - more teaching training and working with teachers to change their Tier 1 instruction - so even if grant goes away - we will still have that

Dr. Chiesa - As you know, we purchased enhanced core programs - once training is done, we can carry it forward in years to come

Mr. Teixeira - With the EL grant, we could always have the option to use Title 3 monies - would have to see what the participation would be

Member Ruseau - Glad you think about this - thank you

Mr. Teixeira- We aren't taking on something new with both grants - it is stuff we have already done, and building on what we already do

Mayor - Thank you Mr. Teixeira and Dr. Chiesa. We will move onto the Extended School Year Programming with Ms. Bowen and Ms. Campbell

Ms. Bowen - We began our 6 week program from July 6th - August 14th, with a wide range of services both in person and remotely, with 170 students receiving these students - Suzanna is coordinator of extended year which follows DESE guidance - they were very specific that special

education would look very different this summer - if we can provide in person services especially for our students who may have regressed, we addressed that. Each of the students have received a remote learning plan, schedule, links, office hours and any other important information for parents - I want to thank Toni Wray and all of the special education staff, as this has been a huge undertaking with Covid 19 restrictions

Member McLaughlin - Thank you Joan - I guess DESE provided a statement for an effective ESY - to students who have IEPs showing regression or staying the same from Sept to June, how many are receiving in person services?

Ms. Campbell - 170 students are receiving services with 62 being our most vulnerable. At this time, 45 who have opted in for in person, while 7 will stay remote and 10 parents still have to get back to us .

Member McLaughlin - You stated 45 students are receiving in person - what kind of services are they receiving?

Ms. Campbell - In person academic services - 1 on 1 or very small groups - we are able to provide in person PT if on their IEP. But, we aren't able to provide OT and speech language services, as we don't have sufficient equity for staffing. Originally, ESY said we should plan for fully remote - then DESE got back to us, June 8th, and suggested offering a limited amount of in person for our most vulnerable students, but by that time, staff was no longer available or could not obtain child care so they could be free to provide these services. So those services are via zoom

Member McLaughlin - not getting in person services with OT and speech language services - in terms of equity we don't have enough staff equitably - How does DESE respond to that?

Ms. Bowen - we have been told provide as many as you can - limited is in the guidance - I've called around to other districts in area: Malden, Stoneham, Winthrop for example, are only doing fully remote

Member McLaughlin - What about PPE? Do we have enough?

Ms. Bowen - Yes we do - It was one of our priorities

Member McLaughlin - clear masks and shields? What about professional development provided for families and teachers - I'm trying to understand - can you share with us?

Ms. Bowen - We are working on the training of staff when students come into building and when students leave and how the classrooms have to be cleaned

Ms. Campbell - Training for staff this week was held this week - All PPE gowns, N95 masks and face shields - as some students won't be able to wear face masks 1-1 as necessary - Ms. Wray will be sending a protocol home to parents - a checklist handed to teacher each day - new checklist daily

Member McLaughlin - can you share a checklist with us? There was no prioritizing?

Ms. Bowen - We had to function by staff availability only

Member McLaughlin - If we can't provide ESY services in July, how can we expect those services once school starts?

Ms. Bowen - I'm not sure I have an answer for you - we have to start planning for the fall - hopefully working together we will get those questions answered

Ms. Campbell - the guidance is changing too - new guidance for fall - but ESY was provided in June - fall will look different

Member McLaughlin - Through the chair, maybe Joan can be on the August agenda with an update of what worked and what didn't? Some students with significant disabilities haven't received one on one support since March 12th. What about restraints with the gear and helping children to the bathroom, etc? Will DESE provide a list of provisions to clearly understand each other for our most vulnerable?

Ms. Campbell - I can survey the staff/parents - what worked well - and will provide it to the school committee

Member McLaughlin - We want to support our families of our most vulnerable

Member Van der Kloot - clearly we have faculty members who aren't feeling comfortable 1-1 - when do we ask our staff their decisions for Fall? For planning purposes - do we need to work with the union? To send out a survey?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We are working with Union to get those numbers - for amount of staff that will be impacted - we also want to respect Hipaa, etc, as well as, primary caregivers for an elderly person or those with underlying medical conditions

Member Van der Kloot - Maybe we could hire from other districts? I'm sure some have made a decision

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I'd need some legal guidance on this - if we don't have enough in person - so I'll look into that

Member Graham - I'm curious - what is effective for delivery of services remotely? We need to get honest about this, if speech therapy isn't effective via remote delivery for example. I think we need to know. Then we know what we must protect for in person services - to interact with our teacher's union - without this data we can't do it in a thoughtful and meaningful way.

Ms. Campbell - Families were given options via a phone call with me. It is very individual to a student and family and one model won't work well in each area for each family

Member Graham - Have we looked at progress and outcomes? Are we achieving outcomes remotely vs. in person? But if worksheets are requested by the parent, yet they don't work, and we are paying for it - we aren't using our resources wisely. That can't be best practice? Or would we rather not want to know the answer? We need to be honest and forthcoming about it

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have to look closely at this, but in special education some of the ranges are so great, we can't give a one answer solution as we move forward. What we are doing in Medford now, multiple districts did not offer in person so I want to congratulate Joan and Suzanna, although it's not 100%, we are trying to offer some in person, with staff available - Data will tell and they will report to you at the August meeting. Also, there will be brand new guidance from DESE for the new school year. Our intention is to offer the best we can

Member Graham - Best practices doesn't mean one answer - but OT - xyz didn't work for them, but it worked for W - not looking for a one sided answer. What I'm hearing is we will have a budget issue at some point in time since we can't provide in person services, so we could go hire someone from outside the district - can't we use some of the city CARES money for it? Is there some amount of money that could solve this problem?

Ms. Bowen - It's not about having the money - we planned via DESE remote only - As of June 8th they changed it so staff didn't have daycare etc - it's not a budget issue - but DESE kept changing the information since school closure - it gets really complicated when guidance is changed every 2 weeks - it isn't a budget issue, it's a more of a planning issue - but right now it is limited and the in person is following DESE guidelines

Member Graham - DESE will continue to change their guidance every 2 weeks, and that is always going to be the answer. It is hard to plan this way, but at same time we have to get better at this - we have to figure this out - to be more nimble. How can the SC help you break it down for it to work?

Member McLaughlin - I do appreciate that things are changing constantly. What are we doing for our out of district learners? I don't get the impression that our out of district families are being included in these discussions and we need to figure this out. There are also districts who are doing full in person - and out of district schools are open - so it's being done - what thoughts have been given to them?

Ms. Bowen - Some parents have opted to transport their children themselves but we have other students who are being transported - there is a list of protocols for that - we also have to let the schools know if the student can't tolerate a mask - we have been in discussions and we continue to work on that

Member McLaughlin - So you'll be reaching out to the out of district parents?

Ms. Bowen - Yes, I'll have that for the August presentation

Mayor - Thank you both. Now we will hear the Report on the Opening of School Task Force with Dr. Cushing, Ms. Galusi, and Mr. Milaschewski

Dr. Cushing - DESE released guidance on June 25th for the fall - best way to describe this process is like being asked to put a man on the moon, in less than a few months - these groups have already started to work and as the Superintendent mentioned we have a number of parents/caregivers interested in serving as well as, the teachers union and the paras.

Ms. Galusi - The meeting objectives - communicate for successful reopening, review our guiding principles, discuss collaborations - aspirations for fall - core values - we do want to create a plan to return for students and staff (emotional as well as physical) as well as a remote learning plan closing academic gaps and supporting SEL. All of this must be guided by our Core Values of safety, consistency and equity

Dr. Cushing - Our 5 key challenges:

1. public health challenge,
2. lack of agreement,
3. lack of time,
4. decisions will be scrutinized, and
5. shifting circumstances - The Secretary of Education was pressed on CNN this weekend and she didn't have a clear plan for opening schools in the fall - A long way to go with a short time to get there - I'm trying to add in a little humor in this

because it's needed - People will second guess and be their own experts and it's their right to do - our groups have to be small enough so work can get done - there are many and constant shifting circumstances - our operations might have to change once all of our planning has been done so we have to be ready for anything - June 29th - we sent out a letter to all parents regarding in person learning with new safety require - hybrid learning - remote learning. Our process for developing a plan - flexible, open minded, collaborative in a fluid situation - coherent and collaborative process and be as visionary as possible - steering committee will meeting weekly - work groups will meet once a week - we will notify parent tomorrow - we wanted to be sure we reflected a broad representation of our community

Mr. Milaschewski - Tonight, we are outlining a process, not a plan - this is an incredibly challenging on how to plan for the fall - trying to be as collaborative and inclusive as possible:

Steering committee - DESE requirements - make sure everyone is on the same page

Operations workgroup - transportation, food, security - what's it going to look like keeping our schools safe

Instruction workgroup - in person hybrid and virtual

Community/stakeholder engagement workgroup nstruction workgroup

Publish them out and then the Building Based Teams will have to try to implement in each building

Questions to consider:

Ms. Galusi - Instruction /SEL - start work in one large group, but may need to split into 2 working groups

Mr. Milaschewski- Communication & Engagement Workgroup - very critical/important - School based teams - will be organized by principals to see how it will look in their own building, but will not report back to steering committee

Dr. Cushing - July 6th - August 21st - Approximate timeline - Since so many parents/caregivers applied, we'll have to select them via a lotter. The parents/caregivers will receive a lottery number. We are making sure this group is diverse and represents all of our neighborhoods and families. We will produce a video of the lottery and post it tomorrow

Mayor - Thank you for this thorough report

Member Van der Kloot - I want to thank the team for this extensive amount of work - a little bit hard to look at timeline - I'll guess it will be more meetings than that - I do have one area of concern - roundtable discussions of elementary, middle and High school - operations for example - I am a little surprise of more breaking into groups - different considerations for each elementary, middle and high school -

Ms. Galusi - we will see once we are in the groups, we may have to further breakdown groups

Dr. Cushing - we will have to attack this work immediately and as quickly as possible - we will need focus for the best possible path for our staff and students -

Member Ruseau- What about the ventilation system at MHS??

Dr. Cushing - Alicia Hunt will be assisting us as well

Member Ruseau - Will there be ground rules? Whether we have the staff or the money to implement the plan? OR will the plan be based on what we have for staff and money and exclude things that are reasonable but can't include for one reason or another.

Ms. Galusi - I'd want more information before I respond to that - we have a very tight timeline - we don't really have the time to create plans outside of our current budget - in the interest of time

Member Ruseau - But if we can't help every student? Is it not a question to ask? If we needed more money, could we plan for it?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The plan presented to you encompasses the entire community - I really want to implore that we move forward with this plan - to ensure its an equitable process - There will be alternates so that all meetings have full participation at all times

Member Ruseau - I feel like each committee has to have ground rules

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have spent countless hours already on the budget. We have to work with the budget we have, knowing we have Ch 70 monies and possibly federal money coming to us. But none of it would be available anyway until late August at best. We need to move forward here, we need to begin this work as soon as possible, so we can present a robust plan. We truly want it to be an inclusive process - we have sample plans out there - Lexington shared

their plans - but what do we need for Medford students? We can't come up with a plan that could use additional funding, as well as, one with our present budget. No time for that. We can always add if we receive additional funding later. All the feedback we have received is being put to work. We realize additional guidance and possible funding will be coming in. I have to express this sense of urgency here

Mr. Milaschewski - If I can respond to Member Van der Kloot - smaller groups we have been toying with that for specific age groups, but will we have too many groups so we will have to compromise on what works. To Member Ruseau's point - we have an obligation to produce what school will look like in all 3 models - we are going to try to explore it all

Member McLaughlin - We appreciate all the hard work - Leading with compassion, be kind and compromise. If I may, what is a Superintendent Designee?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Well, for example, one designee will be Tonya Sullivan from SEPAC for example. This is how that will be utilized so that key representatives are insured

Member McLaughlin - Can this put powerpoint be posted online? Talking data collection is important I would really like to see that quantitative and quality and the cross communication between groups

Member Van der Kloot - I make a motion to approve this plan, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Member Graham - I'd to acknowledge that the leaders of these groups need to be nimble and the members have to be nimble - not splitting hairs over subgroups or not - as someone who does this for a living, you can only act once you start the work - pull in people that are needed. I think I also have to make a comment around trust --- trust is complicated in this world of covid - we want to trust our leaders, we want to trust the Academy of Pediatrics, for example. So, I would ask that we do a plan for both 3 ft apart and 6 ft apart, as there are real divisions on that matter. We have to be honest. When you have to plan for something like this as rapidly as we do, it's incredibly hard to do it within the budget we are in. Solutions can't happen in this box we are in right now. I feel like ideas need to be put down in writing, even if we don't have funding for it. We have to allow ourselves to realize we may have to bring ideas back to the negotiation table, members can think in an unencumbered way. So despite the current budget situation, how are we capturing really great ideas that cost money?

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Reopening task force has been approved

Mayor - There is no old business or communications

Mayor -Resolutions:

Offered by Mayor Lungo-Koehn - Middle School Principals explore mentor program for incoming 6th graders with an older student in the building.

Member McLaughlin - Thank you for this. Please plan to include our special education,EL and our out of district students.

Motion to approve by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member/Mclaughlin

Roll Call - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Member Graham Resolution that the engagement, communications and strategic planning subcommittee meet to discuss the next steps for community engagement around distance learning since roundtables are complete, and develop brief survey on remote learning plan

Member Van der Kloot - this resembles the work of the task force for community engagement

Member Graham - There is overlap here, but the intent is around what the next distance learning plan will look like? The subcommittee can get ahead of the next distance learning plan

Member McLaughlin - I'm curious about the process? As a new member, can't the chair of the subcommittee call the meeting. This shouldn't need to be a resolution ...?

Member Graham - simply that this larger committee is in the works and is coming - I'm just trying to be proactive for the version 3 distance learning plan and provide courtesy to committee

Motion to approve by Member Graham, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Roll Call - 7-0 - motion passes

Mayor - Member Graham Resolution that curriculum subcommittee conduct a review of the world language offerings from K-12 and be it resolved that the plan be presented to the full committee no later than January 31, 2021.

Motion to approve by Member Graham, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes

Member Graham -Just by way of context, we did have some surveying done of our incoming 6th grade class. But with the elimination of italian program, I don't think we committed to a language for next year

Member McLaughlin - ASL - is taught in school and could be considered a language offered as well

Mayor - Resolution by Member Van der Kloot - Be it resolved that we commit to a culturally diverse learning environment, by providing our students with diverse role models and commit our district to recruitment, hiring and retention and mentoring to attract and retain candidates of color. Further the personnel subcommittee will articulate steps toward a goal of a workforce of 10% diverse in 3 years

Member Van der Kloot - I think this speaks for itself and it is a necessity

Member McLaughlin - The person who was leading our task force on racial issues has left the district. How will we address that...maybe at our August meeting?

Member Ruseau - Recruiting cost money - we have to make an investment in this - I fully support it - but without a line item in the budget-- there are job fairs all over this country for example - posting on a website is not recruitment

Member Van der Kloot - that's why I sent it to the personnel subcommittee - we have done it before we have allocated money in the past for a recruiter

Member Graham - is it legal to put a goal like this in writing? It's a quota essentially - do we strike it to avoid hot water?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We had to follow an order from Judge Garrity - it was an actual legal decree in Boston. I feel that Member Van der Kloot is being very conservative in establishing a 3 year goal. The intentions are important, this is something we'd like to make a good faith effort to achieve, but I'd defer to the lawyers.

Member Van der Kloot - I added it as I thought it was important - I hear you Jenny - I thought having a goal

Mayor - Maybe decide on a goal in the personnel subcommittee and invite Howard to that meeting?

Member Van der Kloot - I'll amend it to a diverse workforce.

Member McLaughlin - I move the motion, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes as amended

Mayor - Resolution by Members Graham and Ruseau - that Andy Paquette conduct a complete review of the business/finance office and provide a report by October 1st, including the district's cash management policy and revolving accounts policies in this review. This will include all areas that the school committee has authority including community schools and food services.

Member Graham - I would like Andy's professional opinion on what the budget/ human resources office should look like to move forward in a more cohesive fashion

Member Van der Kloot - Will we keep Andy for 3 months?

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The proposed contract we put forward was to have Andy for (4) months - his level of support would drop once new person is hired - would go to tiered support - no coverage at this point - so I think it's important we don't abbreviate the support

Member McLaughlin - what I'm hearing is that we will keep consultants on so there will be some crossover

Dr. Edouard-Vincent - yes

Motion to approve by Member Graham, seconded by Member Ruseau

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Motion passes

Mayor - Resolution by Member Graham and Member Ruseau that the curriculum subcommittee works with central administration to create a comprehensive catalog of curriculum & programming at MPS K-12 and make it readily available on the website to be presented no later than February 28, 2021 to the full committee.

Member McLaughlin - I would ask to add a friendly amendment that this resolution include special education and EL supplements and any additional outliers in curriculum for individualized education plans.

Motion to approve by Member Graham, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion passes as amended

Mayor - Member McLaughlin Anti Racism Resolution which states that schools have responsibility to provide students the civil right of free and appropriate public education, it's the responsibility of the school district to be welcoming for all students, that district provide all staff, including school committee, annual professional development on diversity, equity, and inclusion, and the district will commit to recruit and retain diverse staff, and district will examine policies for institutional and systemic racialized practices and implement changes where necessary, and district will incorporate curriculum of racial oppression, works by black authors and works from diverse population and district leaders can no longer remain silent to the issues of racism and hate that continue in our public and private institutions, and that the school districts in the Commonwealth must guarantee that racist practices are eradicated and diversity, equity and inclusion are embedded and practiced for students, faculty and staff. Signed onto by MASC and by approximately 49 other districts around the state.

Motion to approve by Member McLaughlin, seconded by Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - paper passes

Mayor - I would like to offer our condolences to the family of Harold McConnell who was the father of recently retired Administrative staff person Jeannie Glionna

Mayor - Do I hear a motion to enter negotiations and legal matters in executive session

Motion by Member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member McLaughlin

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - enter executive session at 9:53 PM

Mayor - Thank you for your patience. We have nothing to report out - Mr. Greenspan will provide a presentation of information for our August meeting. Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau, seconded by Member Van der Kloot

Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - Motion passes, meeting adjourned at 10:36 PM.